

Frobenius Minimality of the Huneke–Wiegand Counterexample in Symmetric Numerical Semigroup Rings

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Provenance. Son Pham discovered the counterexample; Professor Craig Huneke independently verified it. This paper contributes a separate certified Frobenius-minimality result.

Abstract

Son Pham publicly identified a counterexample to the Huneke–Wiegand conjecture in the class of two-generated monomial ideals over symmetric numerical semigroup rings, subsequently verified by Professor Craig Huneke. We preserve that discovery priority and answer a different question: what is the least Frobenius number at which such a counterexample can occur? We prove by proof-carrying exact computation that the answer is 181, attained by Pham’s semigroup at ideal shift 14. First, an implementation of the complete Blanco–Rosales tree exhausts all 48,954 symmetric semigroups with Frobenius number below 69 and all 1,503,391 associated gap cases. An independent Boolean route checks 1,156 fixed-pair UNSAT certificates for the same range. We then introduce a one-hot shift-selector CNF that asks one existence question per Frobenius number. Its DRAT certificates exclude every odd value from 69 through 179, while the formula at 181 is satisfiable and decodes exactly to the public semigroup and shift. A separately generated fixed-pair formula returns the same model. An independent audit rehashes all 228 files in the minimality search, totaling 760,081,739 bytes, rechecks both SAT models, and reproduces the strict-order manifest with no mismatch. Complete theorem-tree enumeration at $F = 69, 71, 73, 75$ provides an object-level cross-check on another 79,790 semigroups and 2,933,163 gap cases. The theorem is scoped to symmetric numerical semigroup rings and nonprincipal two-generated monomial ideals. It does not assert uniqueness, minimum multiplicity or embedding dimension, or minimality for arbitrary Gorenstein domains and modules.

1 Introduction

Let R be a one-dimensional Gorenstein local domain and let M be a nonzero finitely generated non-free module. The Huneke–Wiegand conjecture predicted nontrivial torsion in $M \otimes_R \operatorname{Hom}_R(M, R)$ [1]. For a numerical semigroup $\Gamma \subseteq \mathbb{N}$, the semigroup ring $\mathbb{k}[t^\Gamma]$ is Gorenstein exactly when Γ is

symmetric. This specialization converts part of the module problem into finite additive combinatorics. García-Sánchez and Leamer proved broad positive classes and reported a NumericalSgps check for every symmetric semigroup with Frobenius number below 69 [2].

In 2026, Son Pham published a symmetric numerical semigroup and a two-generated monomial ideal for which the predicted torsion is absent [5]. Professor Craig Huneke supplied an independent verification archived with the public candidate record. That example has Frobenius number 181. The discovery settles the original conjecture negatively, but does not by itself say whether 181 is small, minimal, or typical.

This paper reports a computer-assisted minimality theorem. Claims are labeled [MV] when they are verified by exact machine computation and independently checked artifacts, and [D] when derived in the text. No conjectural claim is needed for the main theorem.

Contributions.

1. We give a self-contained finite-window reduction and a direct proof that the selector CNF is equisatisfiable with existence of a rigid two-generated monomial ideal.
2. We reproduce the published $F < 69$ boundary by two independent complete routes: the Blanco–Rosales tree and checked DRAT proofs.
3. We certify UNSAT for every odd $F = 69, 71, \dots, 179$, then recover the exact public model at $(F, s) = (181, 14)$.
4. We independently rehash and inspect the complete search artifact set, and cross-check the first four new odd Frobenius values by explicit theorem-tree enumeration.
5. We identify two structural boundaries: the public semigroup lies outside the generalized arithmetic-sequence positive family, and the visible fixed-offset generator blocks do not extend to a naive parametric family.

2 The finite semigroup problem

Definition 2.1. A *numerical semigroup* is a cofinite additive submonoid $\Gamma \subseteq \mathbb{N}$. Its Frobenius number is $F(\Gamma) = \max(\mathbb{N} \setminus \Gamma)$. It is *symmetric* when

$$n \in \Gamma \iff F(\Gamma) - n \notin \Gamma \quad (0 \leq n \leq F(\Gamma)).$$

Fix a symmetric semigroup Γ with Frobenius number F and a positive gap $s \notin \Gamma$. Normalize the corresponding two-generated relative ideal to $(0, s)$. Define

$$\begin{aligned} E_s &= \{n \in \mathbb{N} : n, n + s \in \Gamma\}, \\ D_s &= \{n \in \mathbb{N} : n, n + s, n + 2s \in \Gamma\}. \end{aligned}$$

The García-Sánchez–Leamer reduction identifies the counterexample condition with

$$D_s = E_s + E_s. \tag{1}$$

Equivalently, every length-two arithmetic sequence of step s in Γ decomposes as a sum of two length-one sequences [2, 4].

Lemma 2.2 (Automatic inclusion, [D]). *For every numerical semigroup Γ and every positive integer s , $E_s + E_s \subseteq D_s$.*

Proof. If $a, b \in E_s$, then $a, a + s, b, b + s \in \Gamma$. Closure gives $a + b \in \Gamma$, $a + b + s = a + (b + s) \in \Gamma$, and $a + b + 2s = (a + s) + (b + s) \in \Gamma$. Hence $a + b \in D_s$. $\square$

Lemma 2.3 (Finite window, [D]). *Equation (1) holds if and only if $D_s \cap [0, 2F + 1] \subseteq E_s + E_s$.*

Proof. Only the reverse inclusion needs checking by Lemma 2.2. Every integer at least $F + 1$ belongs to Γ , hence to E_s and D_s . Let $m = \min E_s$; then $m \leq F + 1$. For every $n \geq m + F + 1$, both m and $n - m$ lie in E_s , so $n \in E_s + E_s$. Since $m + F + 1 \leq 2F + 2$, every $n \geq 2F + 2$ is automatic. The displayed finite window is therefore complete. $\square$

Lemma 2.4 (Parity, [D]). *The Frobenius number of a symmetric numerical semigroup is odd.*

Proof. If F were even, symmetry at $n = F/2$ would require $F/2$ to belong to Γ exactly when it does not belong to Γ . $\square$

3 The public model and independent calibration

Pham’s public semigroup is

$$\Gamma = \langle 56, 57, 58, 63, 64, 70, 71, 72, 73, 74, 75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 83, \\ 87, 89, 90, 93, 95, 96, 97 \rangle,$$

with the ideal generated by t^{56} and t^{70} , hence normalized shift $s = 14$ [5]. An independent Singular/4ti2 calculation and a separate standard-library finite route verify $F = 181$, conductor 182, genus 91, symmetry, and equality (1) [MV]. The Singular route uses a 322-generator toric standard basis; both reduced ideal differences vanish. The hypersurface control $\langle 4, 5 \rangle$ rejects equality with explicit residues [MV].

The endomorphism overring of the ideal has value semigroup

$$v(\text{End}_R(I)) = \Gamma \cup \{101, 107, 181\},$$

with Frobenius number 125, genus 88, and type 24 [MV]. This explains why positive criteria that require a Gorenstein endomorphism ring do not apply, but it does not imply minimality.

4 Complete reproduction below 69

For fixed odd F , irreducible numerical semigroups are exactly the symmetric ones. Blanco and Rosales construct all of them as a rooted tree [3]. Starting from

$$C(F) = \{0, (F + 1)/2, (F + 1)/2 + 1, \dots\} \setminus \{F\},$$

a child replaces a suitable minimal generator $x > F/2$ by $F - x$. Their theorem supplies exact child conditions, completeness, and a unique parent.

Our direct implementation validates every node for closure, symmetry, genus, minimal generators, and its theorem parent. It then checks every gap by Lemma 2.3 and retains a first element of $D_s \setminus (E_s + E_s)$ whenever equality fails. The full range $F = 1, 3, \dots, 67$ contains 48,954 semigroups

and 1,503,391 gap cases; none is rigid [MV]. At $F = 11$ the implementation returns the six nodes listed by Blanco–Rosales, while an invalid mutation is rejected by closure at $(1, 1)$.

An independent route generates one fixed-pair DIMACS formula for each (F, s) , including shifts that are forced not to be gaps. CaDiCaL emits a DRAT proof for every UNSAT result, and DRAT-trim checks each proof against the exact CNF [6, 7]. All 1,156 formulas are UNSAT and independently verified [MV]. A committed auditor rehashes 4,624 external files totaling 211,671,241 bytes with zero mismatch.

5 One selector formula per Frobenius value

The fixed-pair route duplicates the same semigroup constraints once per shift. We instead introduce Boolean membership variables h_n for $0 \leq n \leq F$ and one-hot variables q_s for $1 \leq s \leq F$.

5.1 Semigroup and selector clauses

The CNF contains units h_0 and $\neg h_F$, the symmetry clauses

$$(h_n \vee h_{F-n}) \wedge (\neg h_n \vee \neg h_{F-n}),$$

and closure clauses $\neg h_a \vee \neg h_b \vee h_{a+b}$ for $a + b \leq F$. The selectors satisfy one at-least-one clause, all pairwise at-most-one clauses, and $q_s \Rightarrow \neg h_s$. Thus every model chooses exactly one gap.

For $0 \leq n \leq 2F + 1$, guarded Tseitin clauses impose, under the selected q_s ,

$$\begin{aligned} e_n &\longleftrightarrow h_n \wedge h_{n+s}, \\ d_n &\longleftrightarrow h_n \wedge h_{n+s} \wedge h_{n+2s}, \end{aligned}$$

where h_j is the constant true for $j > F$. For each unordered decomposition $n = a + b$, a variable $p_{n,a,b}$ is equivalent to $e_a \wedge e_b$. Finally,

$$d_n \Rightarrow \bigvee_{a+b=n} p_{n,a,b}.$$

The automatic inclusion from Lemma 2.2 need not be duplicated in the formula.

Proposition 5.1 (Selector equisatisfiability, [D]). *For positive odd F , the selector CNF is satisfiable if and only if there exist a symmetric numerical semigroup Γ with Frobenius number F and a gap s satisfying $D_s = E_s + E_s$.*

Proof. The semigroup clauses decode exactly a symmetric semigroup of Frobenius number F , and the one-hot clauses decode a unique gap. Because exactly one guard is true, all e_n and d_n equal the definitions for that gap. The p equivalences and final disjunctions impose $D_s \subseteq E_s + E_s$ through $2F + 1$. Lemmas 2.2 and 2.3 give global equality. Conversely, from a rigid pair assign h and q from the pair, assign e, d by their definitions, and assign each p by its conjunction. Every clause is then true. $\square$

The selector encoding passes two adversarial calibrations [MV]. Every odd $F \leq 67$ is UNSAT with an accepted proof, while $F = 181$ is SAT. The latter formula has 34,397 variables and 363,912 clauses, selects $s = 14$, and decodes exactly to the public membership vector. A newly generated fixed-pair formula at $(181, 14)$ returns the same vector.

6 The certified search and minimality theorem

We scan odd F in strict increasing order. Table 1 summarizes the closed run.

Table 1: Selector-CNF minimality search.

Quantity	Value
Odd Frobenius values requested	57 (69 through 181)
UNSAT with accepted DRAT proof	56 (69 through 179)
Validated SAT models	1 (181, shift 14)
UNKNOWN or timeout	0
Wall time	4,303.86 seconds
CNF bytes	169,745,433
DRAT proof bytes	586,785,257
Slowest solve	$F = 175$, 218.83 seconds

Theorem 6.1 (Frobenius minimality, [MV+D]). *Among symmetric numerical semigroups admitting a nonprincipal two-generated monomial ideal that is a counterexample to the Huneke–Wiegand prediction, the least Frobenius number is 181. It is attained by Pham’s public example at shift 14.*

Proof. By Lemma 2.4, only odd Frobenius values occur. Complete tree enumeration and the independent fixed-pair proof suite exclude every odd $F \leq 67$. Proposition 5.1 and the accepted selector DRAT proofs exclude every odd F from 69 through 179. The validated selector and fixed-pair models at (181, 14) provide existence. These cases exhaust all smaller positive Frobenius values. $\square$

The search audit independently rehashes all 228 expected CNF, proof, solver-log, and checker-log files, totaling 760,081,739 bytes. It also reconstructs both SAT membership masks, validates closure, symmetry, and rigidity, checks strict odd ordering, and recomputes aggregate SHA-256

0f580de2707a00fdd52e1b3c04e7767b97ce7b0a826593b119e9a49ae04da743.

No file is missing, no hash differs, and no status marker or semantic check fails [MV].

7 Independent object-level checks beyond the old frontier

The theorem-tree route was continued beyond 67 without consulting SAT models. Table 2 lists the first four new odd values.

This is not needed to trust a DRAT derivation, but it attacks the custom encoding at the object level and supplies explicit failed-rigidity witnesses for every tested gap. The routes agree.

8 Structural boundaries and a failed family ansatz

Landeros et al. prove the positive result for semigroups generated by a generalized arithmetic sequence $\langle a, ah + d, \dots, ah + kd \rangle$ [4]. The public semigroup cannot lie in this class [D]. Its multiplicity forces $a = 56$. Since $57 \in \Gamma$ and no sum of two positive semigroup elements is below 112, the presentation forces $h = d = 1$. Since $63 \in \Gamma$, it would then include 59, 60, 61, 62, but all four are gaps.

Table 2: Complete Blanco–Rosales tree cross-checks beyond the published boundary.

F	Symmetric semigroups	Gap cases	Rigid cases	Seconds
69	11,276	394,660	0	137.00
71	19,812	713,232	0	235.37
73	25,405	939,985	0	333.21
75	23,297	885,286	0	330.10
Total	79,790	2,933,163	0	1,035.68

The seed also displays $56 = 4s$ and $181 = 13s - 1$ at $s = 14$, with generator blocks

$$4s + \{0, 1, 2, 7, 8\}, \quad 5s + [0, s - 1], \quad 6s + \{3, 5, 6, 9, 11, 12, 13\}.$$

A predeclared exact sweep refutes the naive fixed-offset lift [MV]. Only $s = 14$ passes among even $s \leq 100$. At $s = 16$, the generated semigroup has $F = 205$ rather than 207; at $s = 28$ the predicted Frobenius value returns but symmetry fails. This negative result prevents the minimality theorem from being overinterpreted as evidence of an immediate family.

9 Reproducibility and trust boundary

All compact code, hypotheses, manifests, audits, and verdicts are in the public repository under

[problems/commutative-algebra/huneke-wiegand/](https://github.com/problems/commutative-algebra/huneke-wiegand/).

Heavy CNFs and proofs are retained outside Git with hashes committed in the manifests. The proof toolchain is pinned as follows:

Component	Identity
CaDiCaL	reported 1.7.3; Ubuntu package 1.7.4-1
CaDiCaL binary SHA-256	7b73df0a6d9cf3c751a1948300e5baff8e82c4d39bcd88f0c063b5f5cfb8b33e
DRAT-trim commit	2e3b2dc0ecf938addbd779d42877b6ed69d9a985
DRAT-trim binary SHA-256	92f0aa9575ed519d66a99b8b1b3dde6e4618ae4c202a3a4b200265dda0aa7a

The trusted base comprises the cited tree theorem, the finite reduction proved here, the small standard-library model checker, and DRAT-trim’s verification of each proof against its exact CNF. The SAT solver need not be trusted for UNSAT. For SAT, the independently extracted model is checked without consulting solver internals.

10 Scope, attribution, and open questions

Son Pham retains discovery priority for the counterexample. Professor Craig Huneke’s verification is independent external evidence. The contribution proved here is Frobenius minimality in the specified semigroup/ideal class and its reproducible certificate suite.

Theorem 6.1 does not prove uniqueness at $F = 181$, minimum multiplicity, minimum embedding dimension, minimum shift, or minimality among arbitrary Gorenstein domains and modules. The following questions remain open:

1. How many nonisomorphic rigid pairs occur at $F = 181$?
2. Is there a stronger minimum under multiplicity, embedding dimension, or number of minimal generators?
3. Does a nontrivial infinite family exist after the fixed-offset ansatz fails?
4. Which additional hypotheses on the endomorphism ring recover a positive theorem while excluding the public example?
5. Can the finite certificates be imported into a smaller formally verified checker?

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